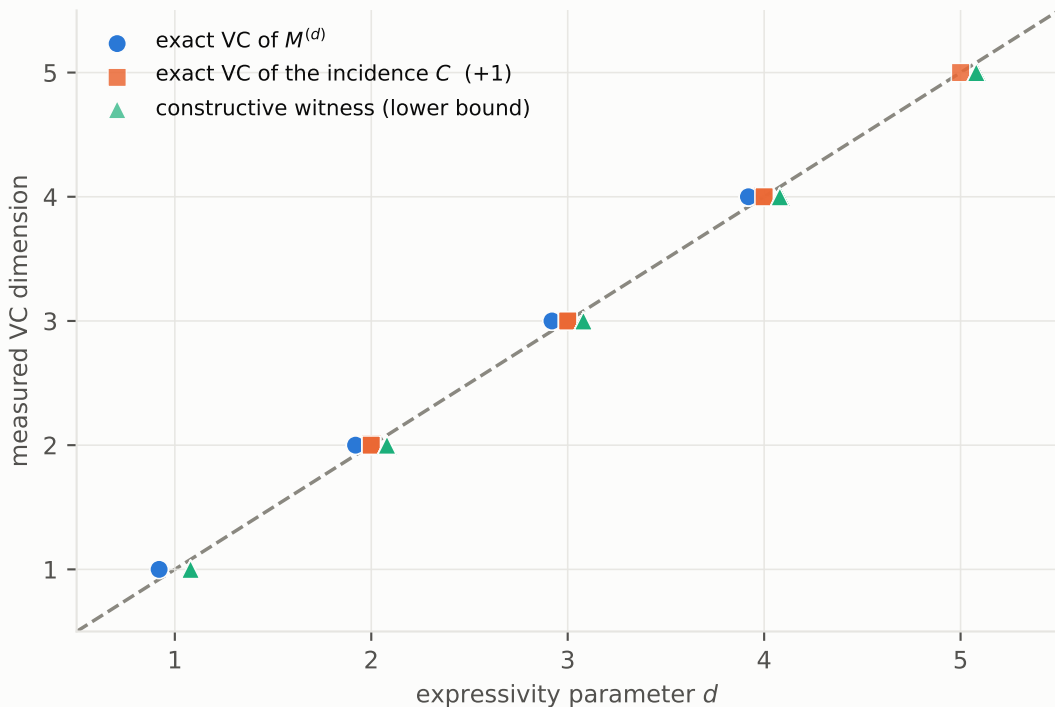


Theorem 3.1(iii), verified

VC = d



Deciding VC is LOGNP-complete, so the exact search on the full $T \times T$ mask reaches only small T . The witness is a certified lower bound at every T , and $VC(C) = d - 1$ is the geometric ingredient the proof turns into d .